

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21



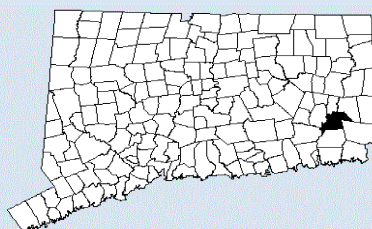
Preston School District

Mr. Roy Seitsinger Jr, Superintendent • 860-889-6098 • <http://www.prestonschools.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-8
Number of Schools/Programs	2
Enrollment	405
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$19,118
Total Expenditures ¹	\$12,101,874

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

Contents

Students.....	1
Educators.....	2
Instruction and Resources.....	2
Performance and Accountability.....	4
Narratives.....	6

Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	197	48.6	48.4
Male	208	51.4	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.3
Asian	10	2.5	5.2
Black or African American	*	*	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	28	6.9	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	18	4.4	4.0
White	338	83.5	49.9
English Learners	7	1.7	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	108	26.7	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	68	16.8	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	18	9.7	*	*
Male	19	9.6	*	*
Black or African American	0	*	0	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*	0	0.0
White	27	8.5	*	*
English Learners	*	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	17	15.9	*	*
Students with Disabilities	9	14.5	0	0.0
District	37	9.6	*	*
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: Fewer than 6

Number of school-based arrests: 0

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Preston School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	29.4
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	2.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	5.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	18.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	2.3
School Level	2.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	1.0
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	2.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	2.0
School Nurses	2.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	31.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.3
Black or African American	0	0.0	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	0	0.0	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.1
White	45	100.0	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	4.8	7.3

Instruction and Resources

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers²

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	7	*
Emotional Disturbance	*	*
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	*	*
Other Health Impairment	25	75.8
Other Disabilities	0	0
Speech/Language Impairment	10	*
District	51	68.0
State		67.9

² This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Preston School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	12	2.1	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	7	1.2	1.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*	0.5
Learning Disability	*	*	5.8
Other Health Impairment	33	5.9	3.3
Other Disabilities	*	*	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	15	2.7	1.9
All Disabilities	80	14.2	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	*	*	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	*	*	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$8,020,842	\$12,671	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$481,683	\$1,112	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$534,063	\$1,233	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$434,132	\$1,003	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$451,990	\$1,044	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$183,484	\$424	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$1,146,799	\$2,648	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$811,116	\$1,312	\$1,159
Food services	\$37,765	\$87	\$21
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$151
Total	\$12,101,874	\$19,118	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$845,006	28.4	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$449,377	15.1	11.1
Other Salaries	\$139,330	4.7	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$357,260	12.0	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$278,013	9.3	5.4
Special Education Tuition	\$814,032	27.4	22.5
Supplies	\$40,464	1.4	0.5
Property Services	.	.	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$45,823	1.5	7.2
Equipment	\$4,250	0.1	0.2
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$2,973,555	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		24.6	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	72.4
State	25.2
Federal	2.3
Tuition & Other	.

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Preston School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

READING	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Preston School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	9.6%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	14.7%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	.	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	N/A	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		95.6%	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		.	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		.	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		.	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		.	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	.	.	.	.	.

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Preston School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Preston Public Schools is committed to caring for students, family, and staff in the challenging times of COVID-19 and always. We are dedicated to promoting the growth and development of all students. In recent years, the district has made significant progress in various policy redesigns, physical plant remodels, and technology purchases focused on improving student outcomes. Preston has established a five-year Evergreen Strategic Plan that places student well-being and academic success at the core of its work. The Strategic Plan is in the process of being modified to move Technology to a top priority, just below student wellness and establish a new five year plan by September 2022. The district recognizes that without high quality, fully integrated technology, the district cannot provide the necessary learning experience for teachers and the essential tools to teach our educators. Our new Technology Plan will also have to be modified as we adjust to the demands of providing full virtual instruction to all students. We have established an innovative partnership with EASTCONN and LEARN collaborative to provide tech support five days a week.

Several student-oriented directives have been issued, the district has embarked on an in-depth discussion about race, ethnicity, access, opportunity, equity and a broad array of policies, procedures, and professional development tasks that emphasize the whole child have been acted on, voted in, or implemented.

Over the last school year the disruption of COVID has placed a significant challenge to our work with children. As we complete the FY21 year we are reinitiating our plans to encourage exemplary performances among students and staff. We will offer after school reading and mathematics program for struggling learners who have been purposefully identified for that intervention. In addition, Preston Public Schools has actively embraced Scientifically Based Research Intervention and its behavioral counterpart, Positive Behavioral Support Intervention, to drive academic success. Our Emotional Learning strategy and our internal Social Emotional Learning Team has been enhanced by a full time social worker.

The adoption of formative assessment programs such as Direct Reading Assessments, STAR Assessment, and Smarter Balanced Individual Assessment Blocks have all helped to create a data-based examination of how to assess student competency and develop appropriate instructional approaches in response to the results obtained from those assessments. As we complete this year we have set plans in place to create a data dashboard for the district staff to use to analyze trends and create intervention strategies.

Communication tools such as the community Pipeline, which is distributed to every household in town, the superintendent Facebook page, and the use of Blackboard Connect, email blasts, the Remind App, newspaper articles, student-based activities and a revamped webpage all assist in maintaining and improving school district messaging to the community.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Preston Public Schools are embedded in a small, relatively homogenous community of just under 5,000 people. The school district population PK-8 is comprised of about 440 students. Preston also cares for approximately 200 high school students that attend surrounding institutions. The district employs a variety of strategies that are designed to reduce racial, ethnic, and economic isolation. The COVID pandemic has disrupted our efforts to look deeply into race, access, and opportunity. However, we are committed to reigniting this work with an FY22 equity audit. We are engaged with the LEARN Collaborative and its offering: Race, Racism, Equity presentation by Dr. Lee Teitel. We use the Equity Tool Kit established by the Connecticut Department of Education for reference and guidance. We also have signed up as a district for access to Yale University's Center for Emotional Intelligence, which includes Dr. Mark Brackett's offer for multiple virtual course offerings on various mental health issues and our staff took advantage of this offering. And we are in the process of reviewing our Strategic Plan to incorporate what we are learning into our future planning.

At the building levels, all students at the middle school level participate in an Advisor-Advisee program. This program provides a supervised venue for discussing various topics, including racial, ethnic, religious, and economic differences.

At the PK -5 level much of our traditional activities were lost. The school's annual Preston Palooza and Thanksgiving Food Drive are events that engage virtually every student in appreciating the needs of those who are economically challenged and less fortunate. They did not occur due to COVID. There were no assemblies throughout the year.

We offered free meal pick for all students throughout the year.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Preston School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Every effort is made to equalize the distribution of resources through the budgetary process. Several budget process innovations include business case defense of innovation, "acceptable risk," building based budget allocation, and budget linkage to the strategic plan. These processes help to assure equity in the distribution of resources. A collaborative approach to budget planning is required. It includes the entire leadership team, the building level administrators, central office, and coordination with the First Selectwoman as a budget planning team member. Budgetary decisions are based upon curriculum initiatives, safety and security priorities, and the needs of students.